```
          type: elastic          ❶
          max-idle-time: 15s     ❷
          max-life-time: 60s     ❸
```

❶ Type of connection pool (elastic, fixed, or disabled)

❷ Idle time after which the communication channel will be closed

❸ Time after which the communication channel will be closed

You can refer to the official Reactor Netty documentation for more details about how the connection pool works, what configurations are available, and tips on what values to use based on specific scenarios (https://projectreactor.io/docs).

In the next section, we'll start implementing something more interesting than merely forwarding requests—we'll look at the power of Spring Cloud Gateway filters.

9.1.3 Processing requests and responses through filters

Routes and predicates alone make the application act as a proxy, but it's filters that make Spring Cloud Gateway really powerful.

Filters can run before forwarding incoming requests to a downstream application (*pre-filters*). They can be used for:

- Manipulating the request headers
- Applying rate limiting and circuit breaking
- Defining retries and timeouts for the proxied request
- Triggering an authentication flow with OAuth2 and OpenID Connect